SolarShare — Complete Q&A for Judges & Evaluators

> **Prepared for:** Ideathon 2026 — Energy & Sustainability Track
> **Purpose:** Every possible question, deeply researched answers, problems & solutions

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Section 1: Concept & Problem

Q1. What exactly is SolarShare?

SolarShare is a **peer-to-peer (P2P) solar energy trading app** for housing societies. It lets rooftop solar owners (prosumers) sell their surplus electricity directly to non-solar neighbors at rates better than what the DISCOM offers — while giving buyers cheaper electricity than the retail tariff.

We don't build any hardware or grid infrastructure. We are a **software app layer** (called a BAP — Beckn Application Provider) that plugs into the government's own India Energy Stack.

Q2. What problem are you solving?

Three connected problems:

1. **Prosumers are underpaid.** Right now, if you have rooftop solar and generate surplus, your only option is to sell it back to the DISCOM at a low feed-in tariff. In FY 2024–25, over 12 lakh households earned Rs.421 crore this way — but at rates well below what a direct buyer would pay.
2. **Non-solar neighbors overpay.** Even when a neighbor is exporting unused solar at the same moment, on the same local grid line, the non-solar household pays the full DISCOM retail tariff.
3. **The DISCOM acts as an unnecessary middleman.** It buys cheap from the prosumer and sells expensive to the neighbor. Both sides lose. SolarShare cuts the middleman and gives both sides a better deal.

Q3. Is this problem real or just theoretical?

Completely real, and provable with government data:

Fact	Number	Source
Households with rooftop solar	50.06 lakh (July 2026)	MNRE / PM Surya Ghar
Revenue earned from selling surplus	Rs.421 crore in FY 2024–25	Ministry of Power, Parliament reply
Installation rate	3 lakh+ per month	MNRE
Smart meters installed	7.24 crore	RDSS Dashboard
Subsidies disbursed	Rs.28,000+ crore	MNRE

These are not projections. These are households **already earning money by selling solar surplus** — they're just earning less than they should.

Q4. Why can't people already trade energy with each other?

Until February 2026, there was **no legal mechanism** for P2P energy trading in India. You could only sell to the DISCOM via net metering.

In February 2026, the government changed this:

- The **India Energy Stack (IES)** was launched and demonstrated to the Prime Minister
- **DERC** (Delhi) and **UPERC** (Uttar Pradesh) approved a 6-month P2P trading pilot
- The pilot explicitly requires **third-party consumer apps (BAPs)** to reach households

SolarShare is designed to be one of those apps.

Q5. Why housing societies specifically? Why not individual homes?

Three strategic reasons:

1. **Trust.** In a society, you know your neighbors. The RWA (Resident Welfare Association) is a trusted authority who can vouch for the platform's legitimacy. Cold-calling random individuals is much harder.
2. **Bulk onboarding.** One RWA coordinator can onboard 50–200 households in a single push. Individual marketing is expensive and slow.
3. **Grid proximity.** Homes in the same society share the same local distribution transformer and grid line. This means minimal transmission losses and maximum efficiency for P2P trades.

Section 2: Technical Architecture

Q6. What is the India Energy Stack (IES)?

The IES is a **Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI)** initiative led by the Ministry of Power, with REC Limited as the nodal agency. Think of it like:

- **UPI** revolutionized payments by creating an open standard that any app can plug into
- **ONDC** is doing the same for e-commerce
- **IES** does the same for energy — any app can discover, trade, and settle energy using open standards

The IES was demonstrated live to the Prime Minister on **16 February 2026** and is currently piloting in Delhi and Western Uttar Pradesh.

Q7. What is the Beckn Protocol and why does it matter?

The Beckn Protocol is an **open-source, India-made communication standard** that lets different platforms talk to each other without a central intermediary. It's the same protocol family behind ONDC.

In energy, it works through the **Unified Energy Interface (UEI):**

Component	Role
BAP (Beckn Application Provider)	The buyer-side app — this is SolarShare
BPP (Beckn Provider Platform)	The seller/supply-side system (DISCOM, meter systems)
Beckn Gateway	Routes discovery requests between BAPs and BPPs

The API flow is:

```
/search     -> BAP asks: "Any surplus solar available nearby?"
/on_search  -> BPP responds with available listings
/select     -> Buyer picks a listing
/on_select  -> BPP confirms details and pricing
/init       -> BAP initializes the trade
/on_init    -> BPP prepares draft order and payment
/confirm    -> BAP confirms the trade
/on_confirm -> BPP finalizes, logs, and settles
```

This is **asynchronous and callback-based** — each request gets an immediate ACK, and the actual data comes back via a callback. This handles real-world delays gracefully.

Q8. How does data flow from the solar panel to the app?

Step-by-step data flow:

```
Solar Panel
    | generates DC electricity
Inverter
    | converts to AC
Smart Meter (bidirectional, IS 16444 compliant)
    | records import/export in separate registers
    | communicates via DLMS/COSEM protocol
    | uses RF Mesh / Cellular (4G/NB-IoT) / PLC
Head-End System (HES)
    | aggregates raw data from thousands of meters
    | managed by AMISP (Advanced Metering Infrastructure Service Provider)
Meter Data Management (MDM)
    | validates, cleans, makes data billing-ready
UEI / Beckn Layer
    | exposes verified data via standardized APIs
SolarShare App (BAP)
    | displays available surplus to buyers
    | matches trades, logs on ledger
```

Key point: SolarShare never reads meters directly. We consume **verified data** via the AMISP/Head-End System, exposed through the UEI layer.

Q9. What is DLMS/COSEM?

DLMS (Device Language Message Specification) and **COSEM** (Companion Specification for Energy Metering) together form the **international standard protocol** for smart meter communication.

- Every data point in the meter is stored as a **COSEM object** identified by a unique **OBIS code**
- This ensures data is structured the same way regardless of the meter manufacturer
- India mandates this through **IS 15959** for all smart meters
- Meters must be **Class 1.0** (single-phase residential) or **Class 0.5S** (three-phase) per CEA Smart Meter Regulations 2023

For our hackathon MVP, we simulate this data. We generate realistic meter readings (kWh import/export values at 15-minute intervals) as JSON data that mimics what the real HES would provide.

Q10. What tech stack are you using and why?

Layer	Choice	Why
Frontend	React Native or Flutter	Cross-platform (Android + iOS) from single codebase, fast prototyping
Chat interface	WhatsApp Business API	Mirrors the real IES pilot's UX pattern — no app download friction
Backend	Node.js (Express) or Python (FastAPI)	Fast iteration, huge library ecosystem, student-friendly
Database	PostgreSQL or Firebase/Supabase	Relational integrity for trades and ledger; Firebase for zero-cost prototyping
Trust layer	SHA-256 hash chain (MVP) then Hyperledger Fabric (pilot)	Start simple, add real blockchain when trade volume justifies complexity
Hosting	Firebase / Vercel / AWS Free Tier	Rs.0 at MVP scale
Matching	Rule-based (MVP) then ML-based forecasting (Phase 2)	Start simple, add intelligence once real data exists

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Q11. What are your three core screens?

Screen 1 — List Surplus (Prosumer)

- Enter available kWh and asking price per kWh
- See DISCOM feed-in tariff and retail tariff for context
- Set availability window (e.g., 10am-4pm on sunny days)
- One-tap listing

Screen 2 — Marketplace (Buyer)

- Browse available listings from your housing society
- See price per kWh, quantity, seller rating
- Compare against DISCOM retail tariff (savings shown)
- One-tap purchase

Screen 3 — Trade Ledger (Both)

- Every completed trade shows: parties, amount (kWh), price, timestamp
- Each record has a unique SHA-256 hash
- Each hash includes the previous record's hash (tamper-evident chain)
- Status: Listed -> Matched -> Settled

Section 3: Blockchain & Security

Q12. What role does blockchain play in SolarShare?

Blockchain serves as the **trust and verification layer** — it ensures that no one (not even us) can go back and change trade records after they've been logged.

Why trust matters here: When real money and real energy are being traded between neighbors, both sides need to trust that:

- The trade was recorded correctly
- No one can edit it after the fact
- The DISCOM can verify the trade for billing adjustments

Our approach is phased:

Phase	Trust Mechanism	Why
MVP (Hackathon)	SHA-256 hash chain	Simple, zero-cost, proves the concept
Pilot (Phase 1-2)	Permissioned blockchain (Hyperledger Fabric)	Real trades need decentralized verification
Scale (Phase 3+)	Full Hyperledger network with multiple org nodes	Multi-society, multi-DISCOM, regulatory audit trail

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Q13. How does the SHA-256 hash chain work? (MVP)

Step by step:

```
Trade #1:
  Data: {seller: "A-302", buyer: "D-201", kWh: 8.2, price: 5.10, time: "2026-08-21T10:30:00"}
  Previous Hash: "0000000000" (genesis - first record)
  Combined: Data + Previous Hash
  SHA-256 Hash: "a7f2c9e81b3d..."

Trade #2:
  Data: {seller: "B-105", buyer: "C-401", kWh: 5.0, price: 4.90, time: "2026-08-21T11:15:00"}
  Previous Hash: "a7f2c9e81b3d..." (from Trade #1)
  Combined: Data + Previous Hash
  SHA-256 Hash: "3e8b1f42d6a9..."

Trade #3:
  Data: {seller: "A-302", buyer: "E-501", kWh: 3.1, price: 5.20, time: "2026-08-21T12:00:00"}
  Previous Hash: "3e8b1f42d6a9..." (from Trade #2)
  Combined: Data + Previous Hash
  SHA-256 Hash: "c4d7a2f8e105..."
```

Why this is tamper-evident:

- If someone tries to change Trade #1 (e.g., changing 8.2 kWh to 15 kWh), its hash changes completely (avalanche effect)
- But Trade #2 still stores the OLD hash of Trade #1
- The chain is now broken — anyone can see the tampering
- This works because SHA-256 is a one-way function — you cannot reverse it or find two different inputs that produce the same hash

In code (Node.js):

```
const crypto = require('crypto');

function hashTrade(tradeData, previousHash) {
  const combined = JSON.stringify(tradeData) + previousHash;
  return crypto.createHash('sha256').update(combined).digest('hex');
}
```

Q14. Why not use a public blockchain like Ethereum?

Three reasons:

1. **Cost.** Public blockchains charge gas fees per transaction. For small energy trades (a few kWh at Rs.5/kWh), the gas fee could exceed the trade value itself.
2. **Privacy.** Public blockchains are transparent — everyone can see every transaction. Energy consumption data is personal data protected under India's DPDP Act, 2023. We cannot expose it publicly.
3. **Speed.** Ethereum processes ~15 transactions per second. A housing society with 200 units trading during peak solar hours needs much faster throughput.

Hyperledger Fabric solves all three:

- No gas fees (permissioned network, no mining)
- Private data collections restrict sensitive data to relevant parties only
- 3,000+ transactions per second

Q15. How does Hyperledger Fabric work for energy trading?

Hyperledger Fabric is a **permissioned blockchain** — only verified, authorized participants can join the network. This is perfect for energy trading because all users are verified DISCOM customers.

Architecture:

```
Organizations (Nodes):
  +-- SolarShare Org    -> runs our backend, submits trades
  +-- DISCOM Org        -> verifies meter data, approves settlements
  +-- RWA Org           -> community governance, dispute resolution
  +-- Regulator Org     -> audit access, compliance monitoring

Channel: "energy-trading"
  +-- Smart Contract (Chaincode):
      +-- listSurplus(sellerId, kWh, pricePerKWh)
      +-- createTrade(buyerId, listingId, kWh)
      +-- verifyMeterData(tradeId, meterReading)
      +-- settleTrade(tradeId, paymentConfirmation)
      +-- queryTradeHistory(userId)
```

Key concepts:

- **Chaincode** = the smart contract (business logic that runs automatically)
- **Channel** = a private communication pathway — only members of the channel can see its data
- **Private Data Collections** = even within a channel, some data (like exact prices) can be restricted to only the trading parties
- **Endorsement Policy** = e.g., "a trade is valid only when endorsed by both SolarShare AND the DISCOM"

Development tools:

- Write chaincode in Node.js, Go, or Java
- Test with IBM Blockchain Platform Extension for VS Code
- Benchmark performance with Hyperledger Caliper

Q16. How do you ensure data privacy?

Layer	Protection
Identity	Every user verified as genuine DISCOM customer with valid metering credentials
Data	Consumption/generation data handled per DPDP Act, 2023
Transaction	SHA-256 hashing makes tampering detectable
Blockchain	Hyperledger private data collections restrict sensitive data
Payment	No direct peer-to-peer cash — all settlement via RBI-compliant escrow
Communication	HTTPS/TLS for all API calls

Q17. What if someone fakes their meter data?

This cannot happen in the production system because:

1. SolarShare **never reads meters directly.** We consume verified data from the DISCOM's own AMISP/Head-End System.
2. The AMISP is contractually bound by SLAs to provide accurate data.
3. Smart meters are sealed, tamper-proof devices compliant with IS 16444 and CEA Regulations 2023.
4. Every meter has a unique digital identity in the IES framework.
5. The DISCOM can cross-verify any trade against their own meter records.

For the hackathon MVP, we use simulated data — this is clearly labeled as simulated and not presented as real.

Section 4: Regulatory & Compliance

Q18. Is P2P energy trading legal in India?

Yes, but only in pilot zones as of August 2026.

In February 2026, DERC and UPERC approved a **6-month P2P trading pilot** under the IES framework:

Detail	Value
Approved by	DERC (Delhi) + UPERC (Uttar Pradesh)
Duration	6 months from February 2026
DISCOMs covered	BSES Rajdhani (BRPL), Tata Power Delhi (TPDDL), PVVNL (Western UP)
Consumers covered	~1.25 crore across the three DISCOMs
Transaction fee	Rs.0.42 per kWh (split equally: Rs.0.21 buyer + Rs.0.21 seller)
Wheeling charges	**Waived** within Delhi by DERC
CUF cap	**Removed** — prosumers can trade entire surplus
Under-injection penalty	**Waived** for pilot duration

Q19. What happens if the pilot doesn't get extended?

This is a real risk, but:

1. The pilot was **explicitly designed** to be reviewed after 6 months to inform a national rollout decision
2. The government has invested heavily in the IES infrastructure — PM demonstration, Beckn Protocol, smart meters — it would be unusual to abandon this investment
3. Even if the pilot is delayed, SolarShare's Phase 1 (manual-bridge model) can continue operating independently

4. Multiple states (Maharashtra, Gujarat, Karnataka) have shown interest in similar pilots

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Q20. How does pricing work?

The price is NOT fixed by the regulator. It is discovered through **mutual agreement** between buyer and seller on the platform.

However, SolarShare provides **intelligent price suggestions:**

```
DISCOM Feed-in Tariff:      Rs.4.10/kWh (what DISCOM pays the prosumer)
SolarShare Suggested Range:  Rs.4.90 - Rs.5.30/kWh
DISCOM Retail Tariff:        Rs.6.00/kWh (what buyer normally pays)
```

Result:

- **Seller gets Rs.4.90-5.30** instead of Rs.4.10 -> **+20-30% more**
- **Buyer pays Rs.4.90-5.30** instead of Rs.6.00 -> **10-15% savings**
- **Transaction fee:** Rs.0.42/kWh split equally (Rs.0.21 each)
- **Both sides win.** The DISCOM's cut is removed.

Q21. What about the DPDP Act?

The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 applies because we handle energy consumption data, which is personal data. Our compliance approach:

1. **Consent:** Users explicitly consent to data collection during onboarding
2. **Purpose limitation:** Data used only for energy trading, not sold or shared
3. **Data minimization:** We only access aggregate surplus/consumption, not granular appliance-level data
4. **Right to erasure:** Users can request deletion of their data
5. **Data localization:** All data stored on Indian servers

Section 5: Business Model & Revenue

Q22. How does SolarShare make money?

Four revenue streams:

Stream	How It Works	When
Transaction fee	Commission on every P2P trade (reference: Rs.0.42/kWh)	Phase 1+
SaaS subscription	Monthly fee to RWA admins for dashboard, analytics, billing integration	Phase 2+
Carbon credit monetization	Track CO2 offsets per trade, sell green certificates to corporates for ESG compliance	Phase 3+
Data insights	Anonymized, aggregated consumption pattern data sold to DISCOMs and policy makers	Phase 3+

Q23. Is the transaction fee enough to sustain the business?

Honestly, not alone at small scale. A single trade of 5 kWh at Rs.0.42/kWh = Rs.2.10 per trade. That's very small.

But at scale:

- A society of 200 units with 50 active trading pairs, doing 2 trades/day = 100 trades/day
- 100 trades x 8 kWh average x Rs.0.42 = Rs.336/day per society
- 100 societies = Rs.33,600/day = ~Rs.10 lakh/month

This is why we diversify:

- SaaS to RWAs adds predictable recurring revenue
- Carbon credits add a high-margin layer
- Data insights are high-value, low-cost to produce

Q24. What are your unit economics?

Metric	Value
Cost per trade	Near-zero (cloud compute + API calls)
Revenue per trade	Rs.0.42 (or higher platform fee at scale)
Hosting cost (MVP)	Rs.0 (free tier)
Hosting cost (100 societies)	Rs.5,000-15,000/month
Customer acquisition cost	Very low (RWA bulk onboarding, not individual marketing)
Breakeven	Estimated at 5-10 active societies

Section 6: Market & Competition

Q25. Who are your competitors?

Competitor	What They Do	Our Advantage
Pulse Energy / SUPEREV	First authorized IES Trade Platform Provider	Their core base is EV charging users, not housing societies. Different segment.
Power Ledger (Australia)	Global P2P energy trading pioneer	Not India-focused at the residential level. Different geography.
DISCOM net metering	Default — every solar owner's current option	We offer better rates for both sides. The real "competitor" to beat on price.

The housing society segment is currently unaddressed by any platform. This is our niche.

Q26. What if Pulse Energy starts targeting housing societies too?

This is possible, but:

1. Pulse Energy's entire product is built around **EV charging** — their ML models, UX, and partnerships are optimized for that use case
2. Pivoting to a housing-society-first model requires different go-to-market (RWA relationships), different UX (family-oriented, not EV-owner-oriented), and different matching algorithms
3. **First-mover advantage in a niche matters.** Once we onboard the RWAs and build trust, switching costs for societies are high
4. The market is large enough for multiple players — the real competition is getting households off DISCOM net metering, not fighting other platforms

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Q27. What if DISCOMs resist P2P trading because they lose revenue?

DISCOMs do lose some margin on P2P trades. However:

1. The **government mandated** the DERC/UPERC pilot — DISCOMs don't have a choice in pilot zones
2. DISCOMs still earn the **wheeling charge** (currently waived in the pilot, but expected to be reintroduced post-pilot)
3. P2P trading **reduces grid stress** during peak solar hours, which saves DISCOMs money on transmission losses and capacity investments
4. The IES is explicitly designed to make DISCOMs part of the ecosystem, not cut them out — trades are reflected in their billing systems

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Section 7: Implementation & Feasibility

Q28. How long does the hackathon MVP take to build?

1 week for a team of 2-4 students.

Task	Time	Who
UI/UX design (3 screens)	1-2 days	Designer/Frontend
Frontend development	2-3 days	Frontend dev
Backend API + database	2-3 days	Backend dev
SHA-256 hash chain	0.5 day	Backend dev
Simulated meter data	0.5 day	Anyone
Integration + testing	1 day	Full team
Demo preparation	0.5 day	Full team

Q29. What do you simulate vs. what is real in the MVP?

Component	MVP Status	Why
User interface (3 screens)	**Real**	Fully functional
Listing, matching, buying	**Real**	Core trade logic works
SHA-256 tamper-evident ledger	**Real**	Actual hashing, actual chain
Trade history dashboard	**Real**	Shows real logged data
Smart meter data	**Simulated**	AMISP integration needs real DISCOM partnership
Payment settlement	**Mocked**	Escrow integration needs RBI-compliant gateway
Beckn/UEI registration	**Not implemented**	BAP registration process is post-hackathon
WhatsApp notifications	**Optional**	Can be added with WhatsApp Business API sandbox

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Q30. What is your total cost?

Phase	Cost
Phase 0 (Hackathon)	Rs.0 (student team, free-tier hosting)
Phase 1 (Pilot)	Rs.0-2 lakh (partial outsourcing, WhatsApp API, compliance basics)
Phase 2 (Integration)	Primarily time cost (BAP registration, AMISP integration)
Phase 3 (Scale)	Self-funding from transaction revenue

Section 8: Tough / Challenging Questions

Q31. What happens when there's no sun? Do buyers lose power?

No, never. SolarShare is a **value-add layer on top of the existing grid.** If no local solar surplus is available:

- The buyer automatically falls back to standard grid supply
- No manual intervention needed
- The buyer's power is never interrupted
- SolarShare simply shows "No local surplus available — you're on standard grid"

Q32. What about battery storage?

Battery storage is **explicitly out of scope for v1.** Here's why:

1. We want to stay **asset-light** — no hardware, no installation costs
2. The existing DISCOM grid line acts as the natural buffer: surplus goes to the grid, deficit comes from the grid
3. Battery costs are still high (Rs.5-8 lakh per household unit)
4. Adding batteries introduces complexity (state of charge management, degradation, safety regulations)

Phase 4 explores Virtual Power Plant (VPP) partnerships for users who independently adopt batteries.

Q33. How do you handle disputes between buyer and seller?

Scenario	Resolution

Seller claims they exported 10 kWh but meter shows 8 kWh	DISCOM's verified meter data (HES) is the ground truth. Platform uses meter data, not seller claims.
Buyer says energy quality was poor	P2P trades use the same physical grid — energy quality is identical to DISCOM supply. Not a valid dispute.
Payment not received	Escrow-based settlement — buyer's payment is held in escrow before trade is executed. No payment = no trade.
Trade recorded incorrectly	SHA-256 hash chain makes tampering detectable. Both parties + DISCOM can verify.

Q34. What if only a few people in a society adopt SolarShare?

This is the **classic chicken-and-egg problem** in marketplaces. Our solution:

1. **RWA-led onboarding:** The society admin drives adoption as a community initiative, not individual marketing
2. **Immediate value:** Even with 5 prosumers and 10 buyers, trades can begin — you don't need 100% adoption
3. **Social proof:** Once the first few families save money, word spreads organically within the society
4. **WhatsApp groups:** Societies already have active WhatsApp groups — natural viral distribution channel

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Q35. How is this different from just using net metering better?

Feature	Net Metering	SolarShare
Who you sell to	Only the DISCOM	Any neighbor in your society
Price you get	Low feed-in tariff (DISCOM decides)	Market-discovered price (you decide)
Buyer choice	None — DISCOM is the only supplier	Multiple prosumers to choose from
Transparency	DISCOM handles everything behind the scenes	Every trade hashed, timestamped, visible
Community benefit	None — it's individual	Whole society saves money and goes greener

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Q36. What's your unfair advantage?

1. **Timing.** We're entering during a narrow regulatory pilot window — not after it becomes a crowded national rollout
2. **Niche.** Housing societies are unaddressed. The only existing TPP (Pulse Energy) targets a completely different segment (EV charging)
3. **Trust model.** RWA-first onboarding solves the trust/adoption problem that kills most marketplace startups
4. **Documentation.** We have 7 detailed documents (PRD, TRD, backend schema, UI/UX brief, app flow, implementation plan, market analysis) — more rigorous than most seed-stage startups

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Q37. Can you actually register as a BAP?

Yes. The Beckn Protocol is open-source. BAP registration is handled through **REC Limited's onboarding pathway.** The process is:

1. Apply to REC Limited (nodal agency for IES)
2. Demonstrate technical compliance with Beckn specifications
3. Pass security and interoperability testing
4. Receive BAP authorization to operate on the UEI network

This process is new and evolving as of 2026 — we plan for schedule flexibility here. Phase 2 (Month 3-6) is dedicated to this.

Q38. What if the government shuts down the IES?

Extremely unlikely because:

1. The PM personally witnessed the IES demonstration
2. Rs.28,000+ crore in subsidies already disbursed for rooftop solar
3. 7.24 crore smart meters already installed (massive sunk investment)
4. The Beckn Protocol powers ONDC, UHI (health), and DSEP (education) — it's not going away
5. India's 150 GW+ solar capacity needs better monetization mechanisms — the problem only grows

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Q39. What's your exit strategy?

Multiple options:

1. **Acquisition** by a DISCOM, energy company, or fintech wanting to enter energy trading
2. **Acquisition** by Pulse Energy or another TPP wanting to expand into housing societies
3. **Revenue-generating SaaS** — sustainable independent business at scale
4. **IPO** — if the P2P energy market reaches the projected $10.4 billion by 2034

But honestly, as students at a hackathon, our immediate goal is **validation** — proving the model works in one society before thinking about exits.

Q40. What would you do with Rs.50 lakh in funding?

Allocation	Amount	Purpose
Engineering team (3-4 devs)	Rs.20 lakh	6-month runway for full-time development
DISCOM partnership & compliance	Rs.10 lakh	Legal, BAP registration, AMISP integration
Community onboarding	Rs.8 lakh	RWA partnerships, WhatsApp campaigns, on-ground activation
Cloud infrastructure	Rs.5 lakh	Production-grade hosting, security, monitoring
Working capital	Rs.7 lakh	Buffer for unexpected costs

Q41. Why should we pick your team?

1. **We understand the domain deeply.** We've researched IES, Beckn, DERC pilot, DLMS/COSEM, CEA regulations — not just surface-level buzzwords.
2. **We've already done the work.** 7 detailed documents (PRD, TRD, Backend Schema, UI/UX Brief, App Flow, Implementation Plan, Market Analysis) — this isn't a weekend idea.
3. **Our approach is realistic.** We're not claiming to disrupt DISCOMs on day 1. We're building one society at a time, starting in pilot-approved zones only.
4. **The timing is perfect.** The IES pilot is live RIGHT NOW. Building during the pilot gives us a first-mover advantage that won't exist once 50 apps enter the market.

Remember: The strongest answer to any challenge question is always:
"The government has already validated this. IES is live. The pilot is running. We're just building the app that reaches households — which is exactly what the pilot is designed to onboard."